

Alex J. Rivera

Senior Software Engineer

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Results-driven Senior Software Engineer with 7+ years of experience designing, building, and scaling distributed systems and cloud-native applications. Proven track record of delivering high-impact features that improve performance and reliability for millions of users. Proficient in full-stack development with a focus on back-end architecture, API design, and DevOps practices. Passionate about clean code, developer experience, and mentoring engineering teams.

EXPERIENCE

Nexus Technologies

Jan 2022 – Present

Senior Software Engineer

Architected and led the migration of a monolithic Ruby on Rails application to a microservices architecture using Node.js and Kubernetes, reducing deployment frequency from bi-weekly to multiple times per day.

Designed and implemented a real-time event streaming pipeline using Apache Kafka and AWS Lambda, processing over 50 million events per day with 99.99% uptime.

Reduced API response latency by 68% by introducing Redis caching layers and optimizing PostgreSQL query plans across the core transaction service.

Mentored a team of 4 junior and mid-level engineers through bi-weekly 1:1s, code reviews, and internal tech talks, contributing to 2 team promotions.

Championed and implemented a company-wide shift to trunk-based development with feature flags, eliminating long-lived feature branches and reducing merge conflicts by 90%.

CloudBridge Inc.

Jun 2019 – Dec 2021

Software Engineer II

Built and maintained RESTful and GraphQL APIs consumed by 3 internal teams and 2 external enterprise clients, serving 1.2 million active monthly users.

Developed an automated data reconciliation system in Python that replaced a 20-hour manual weekly process, saving the data team approximately 1,000 hours per year.

Improved CI/CD pipeline build times by 55% by parallelizing test suites in GitHub Actions and introducing Docker layer caching strategies.

Collaborated with the product and design teams to deliver a full-stack Next.js dashboard for enterprise clients, increasing user engagement metrics by 40%.

Authored internal developer documentation and runbooks that reduced on-call incident resolution time from an average of 45 minutes to under 15 minutes.

StartupForge

Aug 2017 – May 2019

Software Engineer

Developed core features for a SaaS B2B platform from 0 to 1, including user authentication (OAuth 2.0 / JWT), billing integrations (Stripe), and role-based access control.

Built responsive React front-end components and a Node.js/Express back-end, delivering the MVP that secured a \$2M seed funding round.

Instrumented application monitoring and alerting using Datadog and PagerDuty, achieving observability across all critical services for the first time.

PROJECTS

OpenTrace – Distributed Tracing SDK — Go, gRPC, OpenTelemetry, Docker

Open-source lightweight distributed tracing SDK for Go microservices. Implements the OpenTelemetry specification with automatic context propagation. Garnered 850+ GitHub stars and adopted by 3 open-source projects.

ResumeForge – AI Resume Tailoring Tool — *Next.js, TypeScript, OpenAI API, Supabase*

Full-stack SaaS application that uses LLM-based keyword extraction to help job seekers tailor their resumes to specific job descriptions. Processed 10,000+ resume exports in beta.

PriceWatch – E-Commerce Price Tracker — *Python, FastAPI, PostgreSQL, Redis, React*

Web scraping and price alerting platform that monitors prices across 5 major retailers. Sends real-time alerts via email and SMS (Twilio). Supports 500+ concurrent user watchlists.

CodePulse – Developer Analytics Dashboard — *React, D3.js, Node.js, GitHub API*

Personal productivity dashboard that aggregates GitHub contribution data and surfaces coding velocity trends, commit patterns, and code review turnaround times using interactive D3.js visualizations.

SKILLS

Languages: TypeScript, JavaScript, Python, Go, SQL, Bash, Ruby

Frameworks: Node.js, React, Next.js, Express, FastAPI, GraphQL, gRPC

Cloud: AWS (EC2, Lambda, S3, RDS, SQS), GCP (GKE, Cloud Run), Docker, Kubernetes, Terraform, GitHub Actions

Databases: PostgreSQL, MySQL, Redis, MongoDB, DynamoDB, Apache Kafka